PAID MEDIA · BUDGET CHECK

Paid Media Spend 2026 vs. the $300k budget

Platform data to 12 Oct 2026 (Meta and Google Ads exports, day by day) · USD (Google Ads converted at 1 EUR = 1.1177 USD) · prepared 13 Oct 2026 by Felipe Cárdenas

BUDGET 2026	SPENT TO 12 OCT	LEFT IN THE BUDGET
$300,000	**$282,524**	**$17,476**
Maximum $320,000 · originally $350,000	94% of the budget · 78% of the year gone	≈ $1,529 a week to 31 Dec

LEFT UP TO THE MAXIMUM	CURRENT PACE	FORECAST YEAR-END
$37,476	**$1,861 /week**	**$303,789**
≈ $3,279 a week to 31 Dec	Last 3 full weeks (21 Sep – 11 Oct), campaigns still running	≈ $3,789 over the budget · ≈ $16,211 under the maximum



What's flagged

Spending ran ahead of an even pace. $282,524 was spent by 12 Oct, $48,277 more than spreading $300k evenly over the year ($234,247). Q1 was the biggest quarter ($107,469).

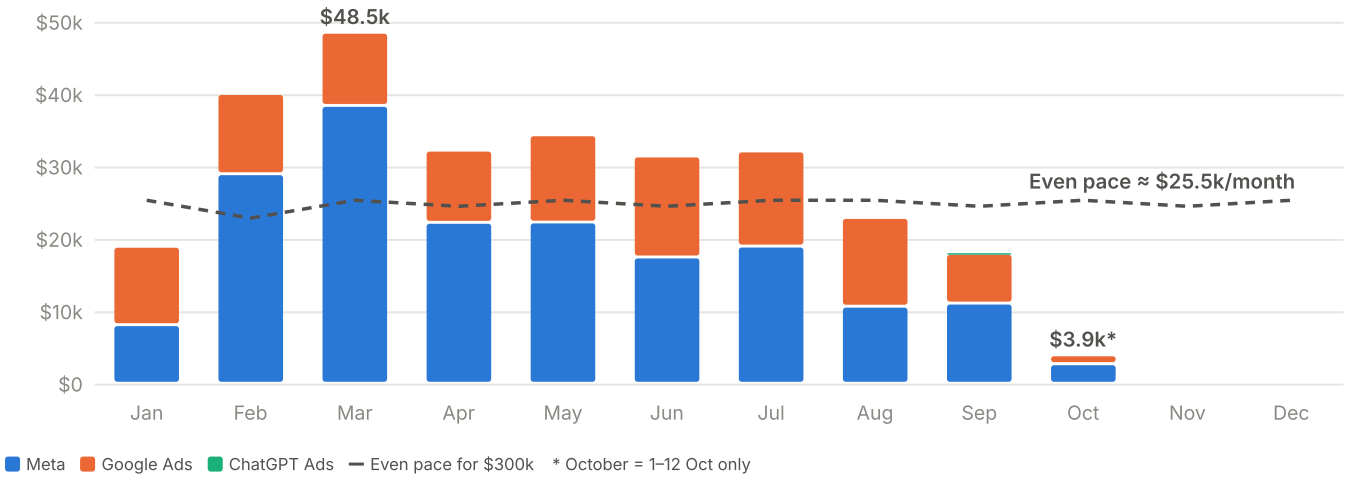
At the current pace, 2026 ends at ≈ $303,789: ≈ $3,789 over the budget and ≈ $16,211 under the maximum. Landing exactly on $300k means ≈ $1,529 a week (18% less than now).

The agency's Google figures don't match the platform. Checked week by week, they matched in only 11 of 32 weeks: 10 look converted to dollars, 3 are exactly doubled and 8 are lower. Their H1 total is $182,516; the platforms show $205,432.

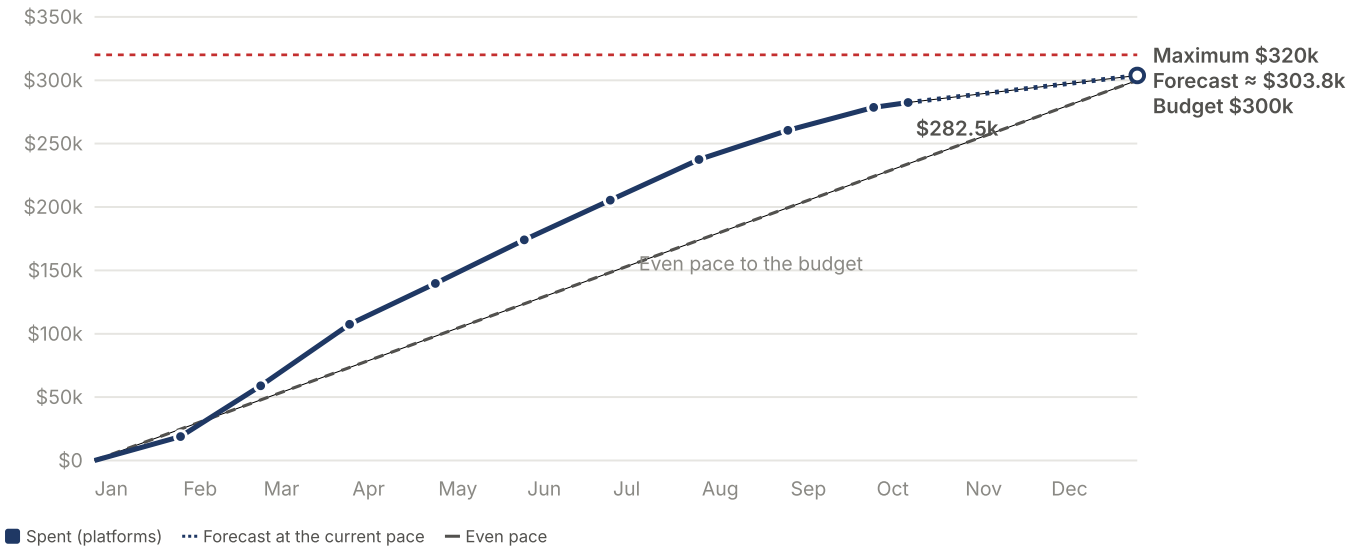
Lead numbers can't be compared over time. The agency changed the lead definition several times (leads, welcome conversions, proxy events), tracking was down ~15 Jul–11 Aug, and MQL/SQL reporting stopped after January.

FR_Alibaba, run by PnP's internal team, spent $4,491 on Meta from 10 Sep to 5 Oct, 27% of all spend in W/C 7–28 Sep. It counts in spend so far but is left out of the current pace because it has ended. Open: do FR_Alibaba and ChatGPT Ads ($257) count toward the $300k?

Spend by month and channel



Spend so far vs. budget and maximum



Quarter by quarter

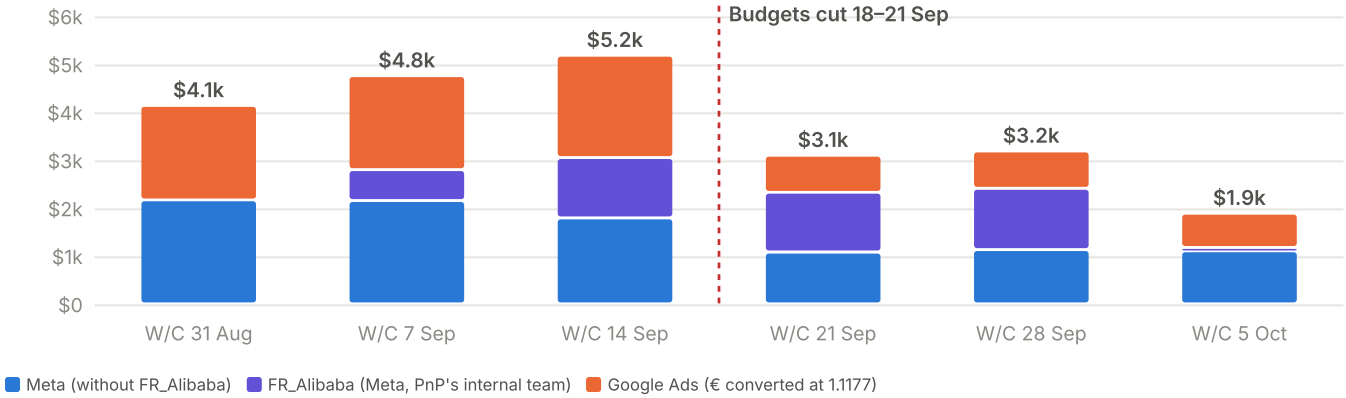
Quarter	Meta	Google	ChatGPT	Total	Even pace	Difference
Q1	$75,432	$32,036	–	**$107,469**	$73,973	+$33,496
Q2	$61,971	$35,992	–	**$97,964**	$74,795	+$23,169
Q3	$40,664	$32,249	$257	**$73,169**	$75,616	−$2,447
Q4 (to 12 Oct)	$2,700	$1,222	–	**$3,922**	$9,863	−$5,941
Total	**$180,767**	**$101,500**	**$257**	$282,524	**$234,247**	**+$48,277**

Where it went, by region

Region	Spent	Share
EMEA	$141,049	50%
Americas	$127,616	45%
Global	$13,602	5%

Region comes from the location code in each campaign name. Meta is 64% of all spend, Google Ads 36%.

Weekly spend around the September cuts (platform data)



The agency's totals vs. the platform exports

Period	Agency said	Platforms	Difference	Note
February 2026	$38,762	$40,037	−$1,275	Close to the platforms, but not equal.
April 2026 – Meta	$24,586	$22,242	+$2,344	Higher than Meta's own figure for April.
April 2026 – Google	$11,420	$9,972	+$1,448	Equals Google's euros × 1.28 (a £→$ rate).
May 2026 – Meta	$22,276	$22,276	0	Matches Meta.
May 2026 – Google	$13,815	$12,064	+$1,752	Equals Google's euros × 1.28.
June 2026 – Meta	$17,453	$17,453	0	Matches Meta.
June 2026 – Google	$15,983	$13,956	+$2,027	Equals Google's euros × 1.28.
July 2026 – total	$34,014	$32,105	+$1,909	Meta matches; Google = euros × 1.28.
H1 2026 (Jan–Jun)	$182,516	$205,432	−$22,917	A second H1 page says $96,486.65, with data only to 24 Mar.

What's working

- The 18–21 Sep budget cuts took weekly spend (without FR_Alibaba) from ≈ $4,057 to ≈ $1,861.
- The agency's weekly Meta figures match Meta's own numbers within $5 in 31 of 33 weeks, so the Meta history is solid.
- The new tracker uses one source (the platform exports), one currency (USD) and one budget, and will be updated every Monday.

What can be improved

- Agree one exchange rate with Finance (this report uses the 13 Oct live rate for all months).
- Fix one lead definition per channel and report HubSpot MQLs/SQLs by channel every week.
- Write down the monthly cap per channel and territory (the agency's location plan sits in an external sheet we haven't seen).

Next steps

1. Decide the Q4 pace with Tereza and Raúl: hold ≈ $1,861/week (≈ $303.8k), trim to ≈ $1,529/week ($300k), or go up to ≈ $3,279/week ($320k) where results justify it.
2. Confirm whether FR_Alibaba and ChatGPT Ads count toward the budget.
3. Ask Thiago before 30 Oct: Google's currency before 21 Sep, the doubled weeks, which H1 total is right, and the approved monthly caps.
4. Update the tracker every Monday from the platform exports (about 15 minutes) and send Raúl the dashboard.

Sources: Meta Ads Manager ('Plug and Play Tech Center – Dollars' ad account, USD) and Google Ads (EUR) exports by campaign and day, 1 Jan – 12 Oct 2026 (they match the earlier monthly exports for Jan–Sep); ChatGPT Ads 'Test 1' (23 Sep – 2 Oct, €229.56). Agency figures: weekly reports in Notion (W/C 29 Dec 2025 – 5 Oct 2026), copied as written and compared with the platforms week by week. Budget: Tereza, 13 Oct 2026. Forecast = spent to 12 Oct + current weekly pace × 11.4 weeks left; the pace leaves out campaigns that have ended (FR_Alibaba, ChatGPT 'Test 1'). Full detail: PNP_Paid_Media_Spend_Tracker_2026.xlsx.